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these relational models. Some of the new data actually doesn't require that. That is where the big shift has happened. I think customers are realising that there are more innovative ways to solve the problem than they have had in the past.

Q What are the gaps you see in the industry, where you feel there is a need for different databases because the traditional databases do not work?

If you look at the social media and at the mobile content that is generated today, these involve very high volumes of data. In addition, if you look at some of the key upcoming trends around machine-to-machine interaction, that is a very large data volume again. Customers are looking for real-time access to this and at ways that they can analyse it. MongoDB provides solutions around it in a powerful way. If you look at the legacy banking or insurance solutions, customers today have lots of insurance policies—for example, life insurance, car insurance, et al. Being able to consolidate those systems once you grow them to a massive scale is a difficult task. One such case is Metlife, which has consolidated 70 different relational datastores into one MongoDB store. The firm invested around three years of its time and over US\$ 20 million, yet could not achieve what it eventually could do with MongoDB—in less than 90 days. So, if you look at some very large scale applications, which are built around providing a single view of data, consolidating products and data hubs, and being able to accurately line up large volumes of data very quickly—MongoDB addresses that datastore requirement very well.

Q At an enterprise level, there is a widespread perception that NoSQL is not good for transactions. How do you counter this argument?

As I mentioned, regarding the traditional ERP solutions, we are not actually out to replace or effectively suggest

that MongoDB will be a perfect choice for that function. There are very good reasons why customers continue to use relational technologies that require transactions. Having said that, our database is transactional and is consistent. We are being deployed in financial services, static government systems and in solutions to ensure that the users have transactional data and secure data. If you look at the enterprise use cases, I think banking is one of the hard industry sectors to crack. If you have to prove the technology, with banking on your side, it becomes much easier. Banking is a difficult sector, with strict security mandates along with requirements around scalability and ensuring transactional integrity. And that is where MongoDB has proven its worth. We see tremendous potential in this space, not necessarily in the core banking solutions but also in a lot of trading capital markets, which involves several terabits of data and the mining has to be done rather quickly.

Q What about MongoDB's community in India? Will you make some effort to increase your reach across the community as well?

We are actively making efforts to drive the community adoption for MongoDB in India. We have around 1800 members across Bengaluru, Pune and Delhi. We see the community thriving and we host MongoDB community day in these regions. So that is very much a part of our focus. Reaching out to our community is extremely important to us. While most of the members of the community are involved in the development, there are some members who are decision-makers—who take a pilot of our technology. So this is clearly a very important part of our expansion plans in the country.

Q Can you please elaborate on the training courses that you offer?

We have three training courses that we will actively promote in the Indian market to those who are planning to build and design applications on top of MongoDB. The first course is the foundation course for developers who are planning to build and design applications on top of MongoDB. It covers data modeling, queries and insert/update/deletes, an introduction to MapReduce and basic administration. The other course is for administrators. This course covers everything a database administrator needs to know to successfully deploy and maintain a MongoDB database, diagnose performance issues, import and export data from MongoDB, and establish the proper backup and restore routines. We have a third course called the 'Essentials'. This course combines the developer and administrator training modules into one. It covers everything you need to know, from building and designing an application on top of MongoDB to successfully deploying and maintaining it. Instead of taking two 2-day courses, this training covers the same content in just three days. 